Need to use a proper script for Samskritam

Even though Bhagavan understands all languages, the power of our Bharatiya languages cannot be matched in expressing our cultural values especially when rising to the plane of conversing with Bhagavan. Of them, the Samskrita bhasha is special in that it is pan-Bharatiya. Hence our scriptures, anushthana paddhati-s and a lot of bhakti sahitya texts are in Samskrita only.

We know that in Samskritam, especially for anushthanam, sound/pronunciation is important. Therefore one should write and read sankalpa shloka-s etc for anushthanam in an appropriate script which is capable of distinguishing all the sounds of Samskritam.

Now the Latin (English) script was evolved for other languages, and we all know the difficulty of correlating spelling and pronunciation even in English. Further, more letters are required to write Samskritam than English as there are more sounds in it. However, since Latin script is widely known, scholars felt it useful to create a Latin-based transliteration system for Samskritam.

In such a system, Latin letters which may be casually applied to different sounds need to be differentiated. For instance in Rama the first or second "a" may denote a long sound. This is differentiated as Rāma or Ramā. Similarly, other marks called diacritics are used to differentiate sounds as in aā iī uū rṛṝ lḷḹ mṃ hḥ nṅñṇ tṭ dḍ sśṣ. Aspirated (mahāprāna) sounds are denoted with an additional h as in k/kh, g/gh, c/ch, j/jh, ṭ/ṭh, ḍ/ḍh, t/th, d/dh, p/ph, b/bh.

However, a system is useful only if followed correctly. If diacritics or added h-s are ignored and we do not read with the intended pronunciation, then the transliteration is no longer useful for its intended purpose. It is very easy to ignore diacritics as they are not in daily use. It would then have altogether been better to use a script which actually has different symbols for the sounds.

Therefore **it is strongly recommended to learn a Bharatiya script** like Devanagari, Grantha, Telugu, Kannada etc **which has clearly different letters to denote the various sounds**. Our documents are published in many such scripts.

However, with a view to help people who are not able to immediately learn such scripts, we are now publishing documents in Latin transliteration as well as per the system called International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration (IAST). For the above reasons, people should use these as a temporary measure till they learn a Bharatiya script.

The Samskrita varnamala in IAST is given below with Devanagari equivalents:

a अ, ā आ, i इ, ī ई, u उ, ū ऊ, ṛ ऋ, ṝ ॠ, ḷ ऌ, ḹ ॡ

e ए, ai ऐ, o ओ, au औ, aṃ अं, aḥ अः

ka क, kha ख, ga ग, gha घ, ṇa ङ

ca च, cha छ, ja ज, jha झ, ña ञ

ṭa ट, ṭha ठ, ḍa ड, ḍha ढ, ṇa ण

ta त, tha थ, da द, dha ध, na न

pa प, pha फ, ba ब, bha भ, ma म

ya य, ra र, la ल, va व, śa श, ṣa ष, sa स, ha ह

-o-

hara hara śaṅkara oṃ jaya jaya śaṅkara

śrī-vedavyāsāya namaḥ

śrīmad-ādya-śaṅkara-bhagavatpāda-
paramparāgata-mūlāmnāya-sarvajña-pīṭham
śrī-kāñcī-kāmakoṭi-pīṭham
jagadguru-śrī-śaṅkarācārya-svāmi-śrīmaṭha-
saṃsthānam

pañcāṅga-pūjā

śāṅkara-saṃvatsaraḥ 2535

5128 parābhava-caitra-śukla-prathamā - **19.03.2026** - cāndramāna-saṃvatsarārambhaḥ

5128 parābhavaḥ-meṣaḥ-1 - **14.04.2026** - sauramāna-saṃvatsarārambhaḥ

Prepare the Nimba Kusuma Bhakshanam and start the puja.
In water soaked with Tamarind, grind Neem flowers, filter it and add jaggery. This is called Nimba Kusuma Bhakshanam.

pañcāṅga-pūjā

(ācamya)
[vighneśvarapūjāṃ kṛtvā|]

śuklāmbaradharaṃ viṣṇuṃ śaśivarṇaṃ caturbhujam|
prasannavadanaṃ dhyāyet sarvavighnopaśāntaye||

prāṇān āyamya|
(apa upaspṛśya, puṣpākṣatān gṛhītvā)

mamopāttasamastaduritakṣayadvārā śrīparameśvaraprītyarthaṃ śubhe śobhane muhūrte adya brahmaṇaḥ dvitīyaparārdhe śvetavarāhakalpe vaivasvatamanvantare aṣṭāviṃśatitame kaliyuge prathame pāde jambūdvīpe bhāratavarṣe bharatakhaṇḍe meroḥ dakṣiṇe pārśve asmin vartamāne vyāvahārikāṇāṃ prabhavādi-ṣaṣṭisaṃvatsarāṇāṃ madhye **parābhava**-nāma-saṃvatsare **uttarāyaṇe vasanta**-ṛtau

2026-03-19 cāndramāna-saṃvatsarārambhaḥ

caitra-māse **śukla**-pakṣe **prathamāyāṃ** śubhatithau **guru**vāsara-yuktāyām **uttaraproṣṭhapadā**-nakṣatrayuktāyāṃ **śukla**-yogayuktāyāṃ **kiṃstughna**-karaṇayuktāyām evaṃ-guṇa-viśeṣaṇa-viśiṣṭāyām asyāṃ **prathamāyāṃ**

2026-04-14 sauramāna-saṃvatsarārambhaḥ

meṣa-caitra-māse **kṛṣṇa**-pakṣe **trayodaśyāṃ** śubhatithau **saumya**vāsara-yuktāyāṃ **pūrvaproṣṭhapadā**-nakṣatra (15:21)yuktāyāṃ **brāhma**-yoga (13:23; **māhendra**-yoga)yuktāyāṃ **garajā**-karaṇa (11:27; **vaṇijā**-karaṇa)-yuktāyām evaṃ-guṇa-viśeṣaṇa-viśiṣṭāyām asyāṃ **trayodaśyāṃ**

asmākaṃ sahakuṭumbānāṃ kṣemasthairya-dhairya-vīrya-vijaya-āyur-ārogya-aiśvaryābhivṛddhyarthaṃ dharmārthakāmamokṣa-caturvidhaphalapuruṣārthasiddhyarthaṃ satsantānābhivṛddhyartham iṣṭakāmyārthasiddhyartham mahāgaṇapatyādi-trayastriṃśat-koṭi-devatā-prītyarthaṃ saṃvatsara-ayana-ṛtu-māsa-pakṣa-tithi-vāra-nakṣatra-yoga-karaṇa-devatā-prītyartham ādityādi-navagraha-devatā-prītyarthaṃ ca yāvacchakti-dhyāna-āvāhanādi-ṣoḍaśopacārapūjāṃ kariṣye| tadaṅgaṃ kalaśapūjāṃ ca kariṣye|

[kalaśapūjāṃ kṛtvā|]

parābhavāhvayaṃ vande naryāpasam udarciṣam|
uttuṅga-turagārūḍhaṃ paraśūjjvala-pāṇikam||

asmin pañcāṅga-pustake parābhava-saṃvatsara-devatāṃ naryāpasaṃ dhyāyāmi| naryāpasam āvāhayāmi|

uttarāyaṇa-devatāṃ dhyāyāmi| uttarāyaṇa-devatām āvāhayāmi|
dakṣiṇāyana-devatāṃ dhyāyāmi| dakṣiṇāyana-devatām āvāhayāmi|
vasantādi-ṛtu-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| vasantādi-ṛtu-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
meṣādi-māsa-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| meṣādi-māsa-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
śukla-pakṣa-devatām induṃ dhyāyāmi| śukla-pakṣa-devatām indum āvāhayāmi|
kṛṣṇa-pakṣa-devatāṃ sūryaṃ dhyāyāmi| kṛṣṇa-pakṣa-devatāṃ sūryam āvāhayāmi|
tithi-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| tithi-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
vāra-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| vāra-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
kṛttikādi-aṣṭāviṃśati-nakṣatra-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| kṛttikādi-aṣṭāviṃśati-nakṣatra-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
viṣkambhādi-yoga-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| viṣkambhādi-yoga-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
bavādi-karaṇa-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| bavādi-karaṇa-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|

ādityāya ca somāya maṅgalāya budhāya ca|
guru-śukra-śanibhyaśca rāhave ketave namaḥ||

ādityādi-navagraha-devatāḥ dhyāyāmi| ādityādi-navagraha-devatāḥ āvāhayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, āsanaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, pādyaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, arghyaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, ācamanīyaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, śuddhodakasnānaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, snānānantaram ācamanīyaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, vastrārtham akṣatān samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, yajñopavītābharaṇārthe akṣatān samarpayāmi|

naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, divyaparimalagandhān dhārayāmi|
gandhasyopari haridrākuṅkumaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, akṣatān samarpayāmi| puṣpaiḥ pūjayāmi|

1. parābhava-saṃvatsara-devatāyai naryāpase namaḥ
2. uttarāyaṇa-devatāyai namaḥ
3. dakṣiṇāyana-devatāyai namaḥ
4. vasantādi-ṛtu-devatābhyo namaḥ
5. meṣādi-māsa-devatābhyo namaḥ
6. śukla-pakṣa-devatāyai indave namaḥ
7. kṛṣṇa-pakṣa-devatāyai sūryāya namaḥ
8. tithi-devatābhyo namaḥ
9. vāra-devatābhyo namaḥ
10. kṛttikādi-aṣṭāviṃśati-nakṣatra-devatābhyo namaḥ
11. viṣkambhādi-yoga-devatābhyo namaḥ
12. bavādi-karaṇa-devatābhyo namaḥ
13. ādityāya namaḥ
14. somāya namaḥ
15. maṅgalāya namaḥ
16. budhāya namaḥ
17. gurave namaḥ
18. śukrāya namaḥ
19. śanaiścarāya namaḥ
20. rāhave namaḥ
21. ketave namaḥ

naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, nānāvidha-parimala-patra-puṣpāṇi samarpayāmi| naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, dhūpamāghrāpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, dīpaṃ darśayāmi|
naivedyam| naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, nimbakusumabhakṣaṇaṃ kadalīphalaṃ ca nivedayāmi| ācamanīyaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, karpūratāmbūlaṃ samarpayāmi|
naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, karpūranīrājanaṃ darśayāmi|

naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, samastopacārān samarpayāmi|

naryāpasādi-samasta-devatābhyo namaḥ, pradakṣiṇanamaskārān samarpayāmi|

prārthanāḥ samarpayāmi|

kāyena vācā manasendriyairvā
buddhyā"tmanā vā prakṛteḥ svabhāvāt|
karomi yadyat sakalaṃ parasmai
nārāyaṇāyeti samarpayāmi||

anena pūjanena agnyādayaḥ prīyantām|

oṃ tatsadbrahmārpaṇamastu|

laghu-pañcāṅga-paṭhana-paddhatiḥ

vāgīśādyāḥ sumanasaḥ sarvārthānāmupakrame|
yaṃ natvā kṛtakṛtyāḥ syustaṃ namāmi gajānanam||

titheśca śriyamāpnoti vārādāyuṣyavardhanam|
nakṣatrāddharate pāpaṃ yogādroganivāraṇam||

karaṇāt kāryasiddhiḥ syāt pañcāṅgaphalamuttamam|
eteṣāṃ śravaṇānnityaṃ gaṅgāsnānaphalaṃ bhavet||

During the Panchanga reading, the following should be read: The year's Navanayaka phalam, Makara Sankranti phalam, Kandhaaya phalam, Rashi phalam, Grahanas, and details on the Udaya and Astamana of the Grahas. Then, the Chithirai 1st date Panchanga should be read twice.

These details will be given in every Panchanga in different places. One should note them down the previous day and read them after the Panchanga Puja, while others listen.

maṅgalaṃ kosalendrāya mahanīyaguṇātmane|
cakravartitanūjāya sārvabhaumāya maṅgalam||

nimbakusumabhakṣaṇam

நிம்பகுஸுமபக்ஷணம் சாப்பிடுவதற்கான ஶ்லோகம்

śatāyurvajradehāya sarvasampatkarāya ca|
sarvāniṣṭavināśāya nimbakandalabhakṣaṇam||

After this, Sankalpam should be done and Nitya Puja should be performed.

navagrahastotram

japākusumasaṅkāśaṃ kāśyapeyaṃ mahādyutim|
tamoriṃ sarvapāpaghnaṃ praṇato'smi divākaram||1||
(sūryaḥ)

dadhiśaṅkhatuṣārābhaṃ kṣīrodārṇavasambhavam|
namāmi śaśinaṃ somaṃ śambhormukuṭabhūṣaṇam||2||
(candraḥ)

dharaṇīgarbhasambhūtaṃ vidyutkāntisamaprabham|
kumāraṃ śaktihastaṃ taṃ maṅgalaṃ praṇamāmyaham||3||
(aṅgārakaḥ)

priyaṅgukalikāśyāmaṃ rūpeṇāpratimaṃ budham|
saumyaṃ saumyaguṇopetaṃ taṃ budhaṃ praṇamāmyaham||4||
(budhaḥ)

devānāṃ ca ṛṣīṇāṃ ca guruṃ kāñcanasannibham|
buddhibhūtaṃ trilokeśaṃ taṃ namāmi bṛhaspatim||5||
(bṛhaspatiḥ)

himakundamṛṇālābhaṃ daityānāṃ paramaṃ gurum|
sarvaśāstrapravaktāraṃ bhārgavaṃ praṇamāmyaham||6||
(śukraḥ)

nīlāñjanasamābhāsaṃ raviputraṃ yamāgrajam|
chāyāmārtaṇḍasambhūtaṃ taṃ namāmi śanaiścaram||7||
(śanaiścaraḥ)

ardhakāyaṃ mahāvīryaṃ candrādityavimardanam|
siṃhikāgarbhasambhūtaṃ taṃ rāhuṃ praṇamāmyaham||8||
(rāhuḥ)

palāśapuṣpasaṅkāśaṃ tārakāgrahamastakam|
raudraṃ raudrātmakaṃ ghoraṃ taṃ ketuṃ praṇamāmyaham||9||
(ketuḥ)

iti vyāsamukhodgītaṃ yaḥ paṭhet susamāhitaḥ|
divā vā yadi vā rātrau vighnaśāntirbhaviṣyati||10||

naranārīnṛpāṇāṃ ca bhaveddu̇ḥsvapnanāśanam|
aiśvaryamatulaṃ teṣāmārogyaṃ puṣṭivardhanam||11||

grahanakṣatrajāḥ pīḍāstaskarāgnisamudbhavāḥ|
tāḥ sarvāḥ praśamaṃ yānti vyāso brūte na saṃśayaḥ||12||
||iti śrīvyāsaviracitaṃ navagrahastotraṃ sampūrṇam||